Texas Cyber Defense Challenge (TCDC) 2026 Packet

*A Red vs. Blue game by **Texas Cyber Range***

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Introduction

Primer

Welcome to the Texas Cyber Defense Challenge, or TCDC!

The Texas Cyber Range is expanding, starting up small mini Range networks all around the country. You have been tasked with hardening one such satellite network of the Texas Cyber Range. Having just been set up, the boxes on the network aren't exactly the most secure. To make matters even worse, there have been reports of a group of bad actors attempting to infiltrate the fledgling Range network and cause harm. You may also need to worry about competing satellite Ranges that may try to disrupt your efforts to secure your network.

We trust your expertise, and we're sure you can hold your own. Good luck, we're counting on you!

Teams

Blue Team: That's you! Blue Team consists of 3-4 team members tasked with hardening the boxes on your network and preventing any potential adversaries from disrupting the running services.

Red Team: Red Team will test Blue Team's defenses by exploiting vulnerabilities, probing for weaknesses, and attempting to disrupt Blue Team services or interfere with Blue Team's hardening efforts.

Black Team: Black Team is in charge of ensuring that the competition infrastructure remains running, and to smooth out any bumps during competition day. Black Team also enforces the rules of the competition to ensure that everyone is on an even playing field.

Purple Teaming

In TCDC, you *can* attack other teams! HOWEVER, there are restrictions. Any "malicious" actions done on the box of another team must be reasonably reversible. There is nothing but shame in bricking another team's box, and the spirit of the competition is lost. Below are the main purple teaming guidelines

- Do not break a box or service to a point where it is not repairable (like deleting the root directory)
- Do not lock teams out of their boxes
- Do not delete critical files if there are no backups found
- Do not impersonate cloud-init or XCP-ng related packages / guest tools (`xe-guest-utilities`)
- Do not impersonate or attack Wazuh or auditd

To play it safe, ask Black Team before you do anything that you think may be a violation of the above rules.

Play safe, and respect other teams

Game Information

Schedule

All times listed are in CDT

Day	Time	Event	Hands On

Friday (4/17)	18:00 - 19:00	Introduction	No
Saturday (4/18)	9:00 - 12:00	Competition	Yes
Saturday (4/18)	12:00 - 13:00	Lunch	No
Saturday (4/18)	13:00 - 17:00	Competition	Yes
Saturday (4/18)	17:00 - 18:00	Scoring and Results Announcement	No

Rules

- Be respectful, especially while purple teaming
- All above purple team rules mentioned apply here too
- Do not exfiltrate any data or artifacts from competition infrastructure (with exception of screenshots and passwords)
- Do not attempt to trick or mess with Black Team, they are there to help
- Do not impersonate Black Team
- Do not change the password of, disable, or remove the `blackteam` user. This user is out of scope and is used by Black Team if they need to get onto your boxes for any maintenance purposes
- Do not attempt to do anything on your boxes during the hands off periods
- Do not attack any out of scope infrastructure
- No broad **outgoing** firewall / ACL rules. As in, no `default deny outgoing` or subnet blocking for outgoing traffic. Outgoing rules *must* consist of a single IP and a port
  - Broad rules for **incoming** traffic is allowed however
- Do not change the password of, disable, or remove the `checker` user on boxes that have said user. This user is required for the uptime check
  - If you change the password of the `checker` user, your service may be flagged as down even if it's up
- No network level attacks (Denial of Service, ARP spoofing, etc.)
- Do not use malware that may harm competition infrastructure
- Any custom tools used (such as "malware" used if you want to purple team) must be somewhere publicly accessible, like GitHub, for review by Black Team. Any link(s) to the

repo(s) containing your tools must be provided to Black Team through a Google Form (TCDC 1 - Tool Links)
- All tools used must be free (doesn't necessarily have to be open source, but please use free tiers of any AI or red teaming tools)

Black Team reserves the right to change, remove, or add any rules listed in this document at any time with timely notice

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Game System

Scoring

80% - Uptime

20% - Injects

Your score will come from *service uptime* and *injects*

Uptime: All boxes on your network will be running a *scored service*. A server will intermittently connect to your boxes and perform different checks based on the service to ensure that said service is up. These intermittent checks are referred to by Black Team as "ticks". There will be a tick to check for uptime every 30 seconds. It is your job as the Blue Team to keep said services up. The longer your services are up, the more points you will get, pretty simple.

Injects: On top of this, there will be operational or business tasks assigned to you throughout the competition called *injects*. What these injects ask of you will vary, but each inject will have a rubric, and your performance on each inject will contribute to your point total.

Injects can be submitted here https://dash.playtcdc.org/team/injects

Store

TCDC has a store available to you where you can purchase items to aid you throughout the competition. Examples of store items includes box resets / reverts, requesting red team to target a specific team, locking out a team from their Xen Orchestra consoles, etc.

All teams will begin with the same amount of currency to spend on store items. There is no way to gain currency, so spend wisely!

The store can be accessed here https://dash.playtcdc.org/team/store

Access and Credentials

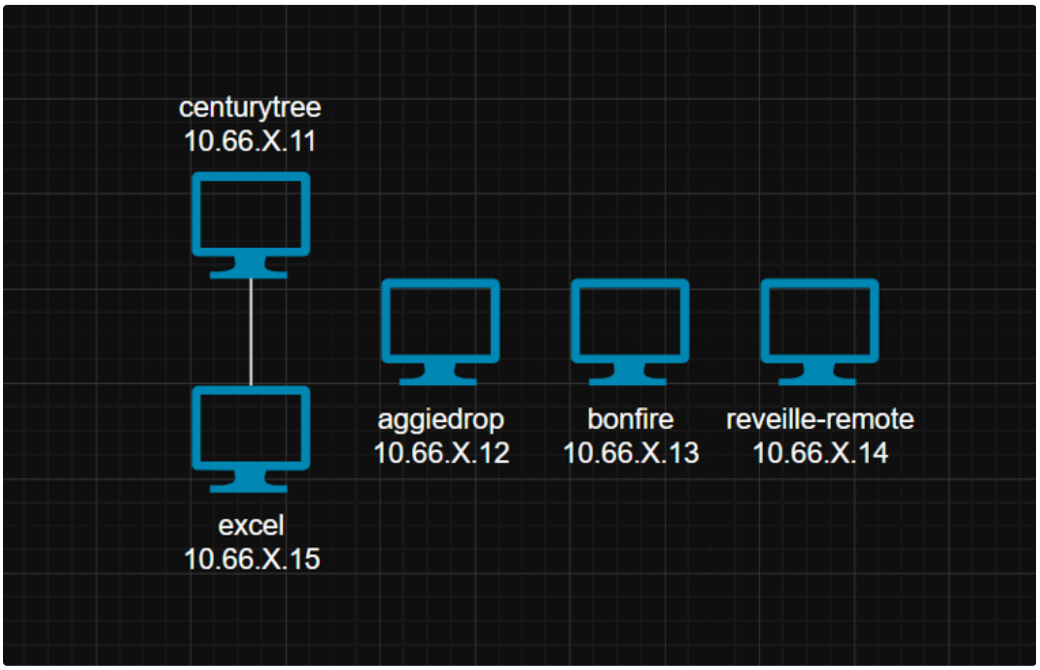
You can access your boxes either through Xen Orchestra (Texas Cyber Range press the login button in the top right), or you can SSH in from your own device if connected to our VPN

Instructions to connect to the Texas Cyber Range VPN can be found here Texas Cyber Range in the `VPN for SSH or RDP Access (Optional)` section

Credentials for your team for Xen Orchestra and the VPN will be sent out via Discord

Topology

`X` in the IP is your team ID



These boxes are the only boxes in scope

Scored Services

`X` in the IP is your team ID

Hostname	OS	Service	Scored	IP
centurytree	Ubuntu Server 24	Directory Search (HTTP)	Yes	10.66.X.11
aggiedrop	Ubuntu Server 24	FTP and Custom	Yes	10.66.X.12

		“Helper” Service		
bonfire	Ubuntu Server 24	React (HTTP)	Yes	10.66.X.13
reveille-remote	Ubuntu Server 24	SSH	Yes	10.66.X.14
excel	Ubuntu Server 24	PostgreSQL	Yes	10.66.X.15

Users

All teams have the same default passwords for their users

User	Username	Password	Role
Alice	alice	Sets0-Break-Subject	Employee
Bob	bob	Ka3l3bs#1	Directory Search Admin
Craig	craig	Worse-Shade7-Happened	React Server Admin
Chad	chad	Substance-Disappear-While8	Employee (Recently Onboarded)
Trudy	trudy	Past-Onto7-Atmosphere	Employee
Mallory	mallory	Faster-Hope5-Either	Employee
Mike	mike	Bar-Large-Tower1	SSH and FTP Server Admin
Yves	yves	Felt-Cloud-Memory1	Employee

Judy	judy	Tree-Sides0-Having	Employee (Recently Onboarded)
Sybil	sybil	Slide7-Cannot-Hurried	React Server Admin
Walter	walter	Across8-Purpose-Importance	Employee (Recently Onboarded)
Wendy	wendy	Easily-Great-Father8	Employee

Resources

Important Links

Scoreboard: Texas Cyber Defense Competition

Inject Submissions: https://dash.playtcdc.org/team/injects

Store: https://dash.playtcdc.org/team/store

Tooling Link Submission: TCDC 1 - Tool Links

Authentik: TxCR Dashboard

Texas Cyber Range

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